

Q I have got a PC with 1 GB RAM, D865GB Intel original motherboard having an AGP 8X graphics card slot. I am using a Ge-Force 6200 graphics card. I want to upgrade my graphics card to one GB or more. I live in Siliguri in West Bengal and could not find any AGP Graphics card here. Do the companies has stopped manufacturing AGP graphics cards? Do I have to upgrade my complete machine?

Indranil

A AGP cards are indeed defunct. Thus, the few remaining cards are priced exorbitantly as sellers know that consumers who want one have no choice. I highly recommend upgrading your entire system. You could opt for a basic Core 2 Duo system, or go the AMD Athlon II X2 way. In any case, your processor would also be a bottleneck for most of the graphic cards available today.

Q I am assembling new PC sans monitor. I have decided upon following specs AMD Phenom X4 955 BE, ASUS M4A78-Pro, Sapphire HD 5850, 2x2 GB DDR2 (800 MHz) Kingston RAM, Seagate 1 TB 7200.12. Please tell me about power supply and cabinet which one to buy. Is my graphics card ok for playing games in Samsung 2233SW? My budget is ₹45000. I am hoping to run Crysis 2 on this system.

Leejat Kumar Pradhan

A I think you'll be able to run Crysis 2, but I'm not sure how well it would run, and would you be able to enable all the eye-candy or not. It's a good choice though; especially given the new 6xxx series will probably be looking at an end of year release. At least you won't invest as much as you would on a GTX 480 or HD 5870. The rest of the configuration is good.

Q Could you please suggest a good mobile set with the following features?

- TouchScreen
- Ergonomic Soft QWERTY
- High Resolution Camera
- Advanced Multimedia Features
- Good Connectivity
- Stylish Looks

The range should be around 13K. Which

one would be better; a Nokia C6 or Nokia 5800 Xpress Music? It would also be helpful if you could provide a comparison between the newly released Nokia N900 and the latest iPhone available considering the points mentioned above.

Medhatithi Guha

A I would recommend the C6 simply because more is more – it has a QWERTY keypad, and while the touch interface of the 5800 XpressMusic was its weak point, add a full keypad to it, and you essentially have a Nokia N97, with a smaller screen.

Q I want to buy a graphics card, give suggestion.

Sellam Kumar

A You haven't given me a budget to work with. Still based on your query, I recommend an ATI Radeon HD 5450 – it's a DX11 compliant card.

Q I want to buy a decent 500 GB portable HDD. Please help with all details including specifications and prices of various model available and which would be better suited?

Tarundeep Singh

A I recommend Western Digital's Passport Essential 500 GB. Expect to pay around ₹4,200 for this drive – a good price. The warranty is three years, which is about at par at what is offered for these products.

Q I have the following configuration (Dell Optiplex 755)
CPU: Intel Core 2 Duo
RAM: 2GB DDR2 667MHz
Graphic Card: ATI Radeon HD 2400 XT 256MB (PCIe x16)
LCD: Dell 1907FP 19-Inch
OS: Windows 7 Ultimate

I want to buy a new graphics card (1 GB) to play GTA IV. Please suggest a new graphics card which connects at PCIe x16 and must be 1 GB. My budget is ₹3,000.

A For decent performance, your best option is the Sapphire Radeon HD4670. It costs around ₹3,900. It would provide

much superior performance in comparison to the very basic HTPC graphics cards which are normally priced under ₹3,000. It's only a 512 MB card and 1 GB memory wouldn't really to the performance.

Q Could you suggest me a good CPU + motherboard + RAM combo for approximately ₹11,000 – ₹12,000. The mobo should be of the microATX form factor with a good onboard graphics solution. I will be glad if it has a PCI express slot for a discreet GPU. Will the GPU on it be any better than an onboard GPU?

Niranjan Ramanan

A It would be somewhat difficult to get an Intel Core i3 setup with RAM for that budget. For that budget, you won't even get a motherboard with onboard graphics. It makes sense to go with an AMD setup.

Here's a configuration that should fit your budget

AMD Phenom II X2 555 BE
Gigabyte MA785GM-US2H
2 GB Kingston Value RAM

The AMD785G chipset has pretty decent graphics performance that's plenty for HD playback and also for some basic gaming needs. A discrete graphics solution would be better than the onboard graphics performance.

Q I want to purchase a good touchscreen phone, with good value for money, reliable. I need 3G, Wi-Fi, a good camera, rich music quality and I want to try various applications on it as i have a Nokia N72 smartphone. I prefer Windows Mobile or Android as the OS. My budget is around ₹ 15,000. Some phones I like are the HTC Touch 2, Samsung Jet, Sony Xperia Mini and Nokia x6. Please send me more suggestions and also, the best among these.

Kalash Sharma

A By recent trends, Android seems to be the most popular of the lot. The Sony Xperia Mini seems like the only decent option if you're looking for a platform with loads of apps. The Samsung Wave S8500 costs a little more, runs the Bada OS and is a much better phone. It's a new platform and there is a community that is developing apps for it. **Q**